# EXAMS

- Which exams do I have to pass to trade? Which exams should I prioritize?
- How are the exams? What do you recommend and how long do you need to prepare for them?
- Since FMRP and RES 12B have overlapping content, do you recommend taking them back-to-back? How much time should I leave between them and CM-SIP?
- How does this study plan look? What are your expectations / experience?

| Exam | Study window | Book by (4–6 wks out) | Target sit | Study load |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **RES 12B** | 13 Oct – 27 Nov | ~w/c 2 Nov 2026 | w/c 30 Nov 2026 | ~68 h over 7 wks (~10 h/wk) |
| **FMRP** | 13 Oct – 18 Dec (parallel) | ~w/c 23 Nov 2026 | w/c 21 Dec 2026 | ~88 h over 10 wks (~9 h/wk) |
| **CM-SIP** | 1 Dec – 29 Jan | ~w/c 4 Jan 2027 | w/c 1 Feb 2027 | ~95 h over 9 wks (~11 h/wk) |

## Financial Markets Regulatory Practices (FMRP) Examinations

- FMRP
- Examination Details: 100 MCQ, 2 hours, 70% passing mark
- Syllabus
  - Introduction
  - Ethics, Behavioural Standards and Professional Conduct
  - Confidentiality and Information Sharing
  - Governance, Risk Management and Compliance
  - Execution and Handling of Orders
  - Confirmation and Settlement
  - Handling Market Disruptions
  - Benchmark Rate Setting

## CM-SIP - Derivatives and Collective Investment Schemes (SIP)

- CM-SIP
- Exam Details: 80 MCQ, 2.5 hours, 70% passing mark
- Syllabus
  - Overview of Derivatives
  - Futures, Forwards & Swaps
  - Futures Strategies
  - Options
  - Structured Warrants and Daily Leveraged Certificates
  - Barrier Options, Binary Options and Callable Contracts
  - Structured Deposits and Other Structured Products
  - Structured Notes
  - Structured Funds
  - Contracts for Differences (CFDs)
  - Key Product and investment risks for Derivatives and Structured Products
  - Case Studies

## RES 12B - Rules, Ethics and Skills for Securities and Derivatives Dealers of Non-Exchange Memberst

- RES 12B
- Exam Details: 60 MCQ, 1.5 hours, 75% passing mark
- Syllabus
  - Res 1B: Rules, Ethics and Skills for Securities and Derivatives Dealers of Non-Exchange Members
    - The Capital Markets Industry in Singapore and Participants in the Capital Markets
    - Licensing and Business Operations
    - Market Conduct
    - Ethics, Codes and Standards of Professional Conduct for Securities Dealing
    - Securities Dealing Practices and Skills
    - CPFIS
    - Prevention of Financial Crimes

  - Res 2B: Rules, Ethics and Skills for Securities and Derivatives Dealers of Non-Exchange Members
    * The Capital Markets Industry in Singapore and Participants in the Capital Markets
    * Licensing and Business Operations
    * Market Conduct
    * Over-the-Counter Derivatives
    * Ethics, Codes and Standards of Professional Conduct for Derivatives Dealing
    * Derivatives Dealing Practices and Skills
    * Prevention of Financial Crimes

## Research (compiled 2026-10-09)

All three exams are **MAS-recognised, administered by IBF**, and are **on-demand computer-based tests** (not fixed annual sittings). They are taken at the **IBF Assessment Centre** — 20 Anson Road, #05-01, Twenty Anson, Singapore 079912. You select a date/time slot when you book through the IBF Portal.

### Summary comparison

| Exam | Format | Duration | Pass mark | Fee (non-member, |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FMRP | 100 MCQ, computer-based | 2 h | **75%** (75/100) | ~250.70(207.10 cor |
| CM-SIP (ex-M6A) | 80 MCQ incl. 6 case studies (18 Q) | 2.5 h | **70%** (56/80) | ~250.70(207.10 me |
| RES 12B (= RES 1B + RES 2B) | 60 MCQ, computer-based | 1.5 h | **75%** (45/60) | ~501.40(414.20 cor |

Notes:

- Fees vary by source and whether GST (9%) is included. CMFAS Academy quotes ex-GST; IBF and ExamPrep.sg quote incl. GST. **Always verify on the IBF portal.**
- RES 12B is a **combined** paper. If you fail any part you fail the whole exam and pay full fees to retake. CMFAS Academy recommends sitting **RES 1B and RES 2B separately**.
- Since 1 April 2024, all IBF exams use 4-option MCQs (answers may be a mix, e.g. "B and C").

### Study period (no official "average" published — provider recommendations used as proxy)

| Exam | Recommended study hours | Realistic calendar (part-time) |
|---|---|---|
| FMRP | **88 h** (CMFAS Academy) / ~56 h (ExamPrep.sg) | 3–6 weeks |
| CM-SIP | **95 h** (CMFAS Academy) — most technical | 4–6 weeks |
| RES 12B | **68 h** combined (48 h 1B + 34 h 2B if separate) | 3–6 weeks |

Average **70–90 hours per exam → ~4–5 weeks part-time** (compresses to ~2–3 weeks per paper for a finance-background candidate). All three sequentially **~240 h 10–12 weeks**.

### Dates and scheduling

- **Rolling availability** — slots open continuously on the IBF Portal (weekday + some weekend sessions). Book as soon as your account is activated. This applies equally to **CM-SIP**.
- **Indicative nearest slots** (observed Oct 2026 via CMFAS Academy; changes constantly): **RES 12B ~13 Oct 2026**, **FMRP ~5 Nov 2026**. No indicative next-available slot was published for **CM-SIP** — check the portal directly.
- **Guidance:** book **4–6 weeks out** to create a study deadline.
- **Rescheduling:** up to **12pm one business day before**; **$81.75 incl. GST** admin fee; subject to availability; cannot change module or transfer to another candidate.
- **Study guide PDF:** available in-portal after registration; access **expires on exam day**.
- **Retakes:** no waiting period — rebook immediately (full fee applies).
- **Results:** shown on screen immediately; printable result slip from portal next business day.

**Practical plan (from 9 Oct 2026)**

**Assumptions:** full-time work at Leonteq from ~12 Oct 2026; **~10–15 h/week** study capacity; employer **sponsors and/or registers** the exams (standard for a dealing/trading role). Adjust dates if the firm imposes its own deadlines — those override this plan.

**Step 0 — Confirm requirements and funding FIRST (9–16 Oct 2026) Do not pay for or book anything until this is settled.** Registering under the firm's corporate account gives the cheaper corporate-member fee and applies any exemptions.

Ask compliance/HR (or Bastien) these questions in week 1:

| # | Question |
|---|---|
| 1 | Which modules must I pass for my role, and **by what deadline**? |
| 2 | Will the firm **register me under its corporate account** (corporate-member fee), or reimburse self-registration? |
| 3 | Do I qualify for **exemptions** — especially CM-SIP (MAS Notice SFA 04-N22) and CACS Paper 2? |
| 4 | Is there **study leave**, in-house prep, or a preferred provider? |
| 5 | Does the firm prefer **RES 12B combined** or **RES 1B + 2B separately**? |
| 6 | Who **lodges the MAS notification** after I pass? |

Also: **create a personal IBF Portal account (free)** now — it keeps your records independent of employer changes, but don't book/ pay through it if the firm will register you corporately.

**Recommended order of sitting**

1. **RES 12B** (or RES 1B + 2B separately) — shortest, conduct-heavy, no maths.
2. **FMRP** — conduct/regulatory; **overlaps RES on market conduct, ethics and financial-crime content**, so study it paired with RES.
3. **CM-SIP** — most technical (options/derivatives/structured products, 6 case studies = 22.5%); hardest, leave it last.

**Dated schedule** *Recommended ("paired conduct track") — done by ~mid-Feb 2027:*

| Exam | Study window | Book by (4–6 wks out) | Target sit | Study load |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **RES 12B** | 13 Oct – 27 Nov | ~w/c 2 Nov 2026 | w/c 30 Nov 2026 | ~68 h over 7 wks (~10 h/wk) |
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| **CM-SIP** | 1 Dec – 29 Jan | ~w/c 4 Jan 2027 | w/c 1 Feb 2027 | ~95 h over 9 wks (~11 h/wk) |

*Conservative (fully sequential) — done by ~mid-Mar 2027:*

| Exam | Study window | Book by | Target sit |
|---|---|---|---|
| **RES 12B** | 13 Oct – 4 Dec | ~w/c 2 Nov 2026 | w/c 7 Dec 2026 |
| **FMRP** | 7 Dec – 22 Jan | ~w/c 21 Dec 2026 | w/c 25 Jan 2027 |
| **CM-SIP** | 25 Jan – 12 Mar | ~mid-Feb 2027 | w/c 15 Mar 2027 |

**Year-end caveat:** the Assessment Centre likely has **reduced slots around Christmas/New Year**. If you want FMRP before year-end, book it by **early November**; otherwise push it to **January 2027**.

**Booking rules and exam-day logistics**

- **Book 4–6 weeks out** — book *before* you feel ready; the fixed deadline drives study (ExamPrep.sg's explicit advice).
- **Reschedule** up to **12pm one business day before** — **$81.75 incl. GST**, subject to availability; can't change module or transfer to another candidate.
- **Study-guide PDF access expires on exam day** — download/print it the day you register.
- **Retake** immediately if you fail (no waiting period), but **full fee** applies — so aim to pass first time.

- **Pass marks:** FMRP & RES = **75%**; CM-SIP = **70%**. No margin for guessing on the conduct papers.
- **Exam day:** bring original **NRIC/Passport/Employment Pass**; allowed a **non-programmable calculator** (essential for CM-SIP, rarely needed for FMRP/RES); arrive ~30 min early; phones/smartwatches/notes not allowed.
- **Results:** shown on screen immediately; printable slip from the portal next business day.

**What to apply for / request**

1. [ ] Confirmation of required modules and deadline from compliance (week 1).
2. [ ] Corporate-account exam registration / reimbursement approval.
3. [ ] Exemption application (CM-SIP only, if eligible) — submit supporting documents via compliance; can't self-apply before employment.
4. [ ] IBF Portal account (personal, free) — for record-keeping.
5. [ ] Study leave / flexible start-time days with your manager (Bastien) for the week before each exam.
6. [ ] (After passing) MAS notification lodged by the firm.

**Key exams to trade (Leonteq Trading Asia)**

To be licensed to deal / take orders, MAS requires the representative to pass the **activity module(s)** for the licence activity, plus product modules where relevant. **Compliance decides the exact set — confirm first; it drives everything.**

Leonteq Asia = equity **structured investment solutions**, non-exchange (OTC) market maker. Working from the role ("order taking and execution", structured products, exotics):

| Priority | Exam | Why |
|---|---|---|
| **1 — the gate** | **RES 12B** (= RES 1B + 2B) | The "Rules, Ethics and Skills" module for dealing in **securities** |
| **2** | **CM-SIP** | Product knowledge for **Specified Investment Products** (deriv |
| 3 — only if applicable | FMRP | Only if dealing in **wholesale OTC FX / money market / ra** |
| — | CACS Paper 1 / 2 | Private banking / wealth advisory only — **not relevant** |

- If Leonteq's SG entity is an **SGX member**, the dealing module is **RES 1A + RES 2A** instead of RES 1B + 2B — confirm which.
- **RES 12B is the hard gate** (no exemption, 75% pass) — it is the one that unblocks dealing fastest.
- **CM-SIP** is the second key one; a quantitative degree exempts it **only** if it is specifically finance / financial engineering / computational finance — a statistics degree likely does **not** qualify, so assume you will sit it.
- **FMRP is probably not required** for an equity structured-products desk — it targets FX / rates / money-market dealers.

**Fastest route to trading: RES 12B + CM-SIP** (~6–8 weeks combined). RES alone clears the licence activity; CM-SIP covers the products. FMRP only if compliance confirms FX/rates are in scope.

**Content overlap analysis**

**FMRP  RES 12B — HIGH overlap (~50–60%).** Both are MAS conduct/regulatory papers drawn from overlapping source material:

| Theme | FMRP chapter | RES 1B / 2B cl |
|---|---|---|
| Market structure, participants, regulators | 1. Introduction | The Capital Ma |
| Ethics & professional standards | 2. Ethics, Behavioural Standards and Professional Conduct | Ethics, Codes a |
| Market conduct & misconduct | 2 / 5. Execution and Handling of Orders | Market Conduc |
| Licensing / regulated activity | 1 (framework) | Licensing and R |
| AML / financial crime | 4. Governance, Risk Management and Compliance | Prevention of F |
| Dealing practices incl. OTC derivatives | 5. Execution and Handling of Orders | Over-the-Count |

- **FMRP unique:** Confidentiality & Information Sharing (3), Confirmation & Settlement (6), Handling Market Disruptions (7), Benchmark Rate Setting (8 — Blue Book / FX-fixing specific).
- **RES unique:** CPFIS and Securities Dealing Practices (RES 1B, securities side) + the combined-paper structure.

- **RES 1B RES 2B overlap ~70% internally** (identical industry/licensing/market-conduct/ethics/financial-crime chapters; only the product-practice chapter differs). Sitting 1B first makes 2B significantly easier — and vice versa.

**CM-SIP — the outlier (~10–20% overlap).** It is product/technical knowledge of derivatives and structured products (options pricing, Greeks, payoffs, CFDs, barrier/binary options, structured notes/funds, 6 case studies = 22.5%), not conduct.

| Overlap with CM-SIP | Detail |
|---|---|
| CM-SIP 2 (Futures, Forwards & Swaps) & 4 (Options) RES 2B OTC Derivatives | Terminology/concepts only — RES t |
| CM-SIP 11 (Investment Risks) FMRP 4 (risk mgmt) & RES dealing practices | Risk *awareness* overlaps; CM-SIP ne |
| CM-SIP has **no ethics / market-conduct / AML content** | Nothing shared with the conduct cor |

**Overlap matrix**

| | FMRP | CM-SIP | RES 12B |
|---|---|---|---|
| **FMRP** | — | Low (~10–15%) | **High (~50–60%)** |
| **CM-SIP** | Low | — | Low–Moderate (~15–20%) |
| **RES 12B** | High | Low–Moderate | — |

**Can they be taken back-to-back?**

**Content-wise**

- **Yes — RES 12B + FMRP, genuinely back-to-back.** Study the shared conduct core once, then add only FMRP's four unique chapters and RES's CPFIS/securities chapters. Comfortably sat within the same week, even consecutive days.
- **Caution — CM-SIP: no, not bundled with the others.** Its ~95 h of technical prep shares little with the conduct papers, so pairing saves no study time but adds fatigue right when precision matters most.
- **Note — RES 12B internally:** prefer sitting **RES 1B and RES 2B separately** — with the combined 12B, failing any part fails the whole paper and forces full-fee retakes.

**Logistically**

- Same portal, same venue, same fee model → a batch booking is straightforward.
- IBF books **per exam**; back-to-back means separate slots (you cannot sit two at once). Same-day AM/PM is possible **subject to availability**, but FMRP (2 h) + RES (1.5 h) = 3.5 h of testing in one day is draining, and both require **75%**.
- **Study-guide access expires on each exam's own day** — sequence materials so you do not lose the second exam's guide.
- **Rescheduling is per exam** — two back-to-back sittings = two independent $81.75 fees if plans change.
- If the firm registers you, it may book a batch to its own deadline.

**Recommended sequence**

1. **RES 12B (or 1B + 2B) + FMRP — back-to-back**, sharing one conduct study block.
2. **Gap of 4–6 weeks.**
3. **CM-SIP** as a standalone technical block.

**Tight single push (all conduct first):** RES 1B → RES 2B → FMRP within ~2–3 weeks, then CM-SIP after a gap.

**Sources**

- IBF FMRP examination details
- IBF CMFAS examination details
- IBF Examination Overview (registration & rescheduling)
- IBF Study Guides

- CMFAS Academy — exam details, fees, study hours
- ExamPrep.sg — FMRP / CM-SIP